Science, Sociology and Public Administration, respectively. That is why these disciplines are broadly categorised as **humanities** as all of them study human activities. There are many more specialised human activities which are studied under many more disciplines.

Which activities of mankind are the ***economic activities?*** The activities which involve profit, loss, livelihood, occupation, wage, employment, etc. all are economic activities. Economics studies all these activities. Today, economics has many branches and studies highly diverse subject matters right at the global, macro and micro levels.

Why some people go for fuel-efficient cars while others go for fuel-guzzling sports cars? Why the poor are poor? Is capitalism doomed to intensify economic inequality? Will the process of globalisation be able to bridge the poor–rich divide and have a universal homogenising impact on the world? Such varied and many more questions fall under the domain of economics. These days we also can see information technology giving a typically new dimension to economics.

Economics and Economy

The relation between economics and the economy, simply saying, is that of theory and practice. While the former is a discipline studying economic behaviour of human beings, the latter is a still-frame picture of it. Economics will come out with theories of market, employment, etc. and an economy is the real picture of the things which emerge after the follow-up to the same theories in certain areas.

Economy is economics at play in a certain region. This region is best defined today as a country, a nation—the Indian Economy, the Russian Economy, the French Economy, etc. Economy as such means nothing. It gets meaning once it is preceded by the name of a country, a region, a block, etc. When we say developed economies, we mean economies of the developed countries.

Countries of the world might be facing some common economic challenges. At the same time, they might be facing some highly specific challenges. Economists, during the period of evolution of economics, have suggested some fixed number of theories and methods of solving those economic